06 | RESOURCE | UNDERSTAND THE TOOL

Escalate a decision, not the whole problem

Keep ownership of your next step while the right person decides.

01	**Name the exact decision** Be specific: "Which coverage option is approved?" is clearer than "Please handle this problem." State the answer, approval, or clarification you need.
02	**Check authority and boundaries** Read the current role guidance, branch RACI, and Decision & Permission Matrix. Separate work you own from a decision held elsewhere.
03	**Gather facts and required input** Use the current source and verified facts. Name missing information. Get required consultation without presenting an assumption as evidence.
04	**Offer options and a recommendation** Give two practical options when available. Explain service impact, resources, and tradeoffs. If only one option is viable, explain why.
05	**Use the correct route and verify timing** Confirm who decides, when the decision is needed, the expected reply, and the next update. Distinguish a requested date from a confirmed commitment.
06	**Track the reply and close the loop** Before sending, plan who will follow up. After sending, record the response, confirm the next action and owner, and update those affected.

> **Do not confuse response with resolution**
> The two-working-day expectation is an answer or a named response owner, not a promise that every issue will be resolved. Verify the next update if more time is needed. Urgent required routes do not wait.

Training basis: Decision & Escalation, six-step request checklist; Communicating CLEAR, final series, slide 41.

06 | RESOURCE | PUT IT TO WORK

Prepare the request and the follow-up

Use actual facts, approved sources, and confirmed timing.

Part	Write your request
Decision needed	
Authority and source	
Facts / required input	
Options / recommendation	
Route / verified timing	
Tracker / next action	

Example request

A specific decision with a useful timing check

"We need approval for one of two coverage options. The attached summary shows the gap, each option, and required input. I recommend option A because it keeps the service window covered. The decision is needed before that window starts. Please confirm the decision owner and when we can expect an answer or next update. I will track the reply and notify the affected team."

Illustrative example only.

When following up on an unanswered request

> *"I am following up on the request sent on _____. The agreed update was _____. The unresolved decision is _____. New information is _____. Waiting affects _____. Please confirm the answer, response owner, or next update."*

Close the loop

Record the decision and any boundaries. Confirm who does what and by when. Share the relevant update with affected people. Continue only work already within your authority while approval is pending.

Training basis: Decision & Escalation, six-step request checklist; Communicating CLEAR, final series, slide 41. Examples and writing prompts are staff applications.